YOUR PARENTING PROFILE



The Pavlova

F G T E

Celebration energy, you follow your kid's sparkle.

Your four letters

Your code is built from four research-backed parenting dimensions. Neither pole of any dimension is the better one.



F — HOW YOU ORGANIZE THE DAY
Flow

G — WHO SETS THE DIRECTION
Gardener

T — WHEN THE FEELINGS GET BIG
Talker

E — COMFORT ZONE OR STRETCH ZONE
Explorer

For fun & reflection — not a clinical assessment or diagnostic tool.

AN EVERYDAY STORY

When the Sparkles Needed a Floor

The kitchen still carries glitter from yesterday's craft when your child asks, “Can we make cupcakes and invite everyone today?” Usually your yes arrives before the sentence is finished. Today your head aches, the sink is full, and even smiling feels like another task. Saying no feels like switching off the magic yourself.

As a Pavlova parent, you follow bright eyes. You make childhood feel celebratory because delight matters deeply to you. But no one can be the weather, decorations, and music every day. Even lightness needs something solid underneath it.



You say, “Not today,” and let the disappointment exist. Then you choose one private pleasure: headphones, a favorite song, and ten minutes with no audience.

That night you keep only the family ritual that truly holds you, a simple bedtime song. Your child sings the wrong words and you laugh together. The house is not less magical because there were no cupcakes. The sparkle stayed because it was resting on something reliable, and because joy was allowed to belong to you too.



WHAT OFTEN HAPPENS

You love saying yes, following your child's sparkle, and making home feel alive. When you must say no, feel tired, or cannot perform happiness, you can feel as if you ruined the magic.

RELEASE THE GUILT

You are not a celebration machine. “Not today” does not cancel the joy you already created, even sparkle needs a base to stand on.



YOUR SUPERPOWERS

1. Yes-day generosity
2. Feelings are expressed loud and proud here
3. You make childhood feel like magic

WATCH-OUT, WITH LOVE

All sparkle needs a base. One predictable ritual keeps the magic grounded. ✨

YOUR POP-CULTURE COUSIN

Jellyfish's glamorous cousin (with more heart)



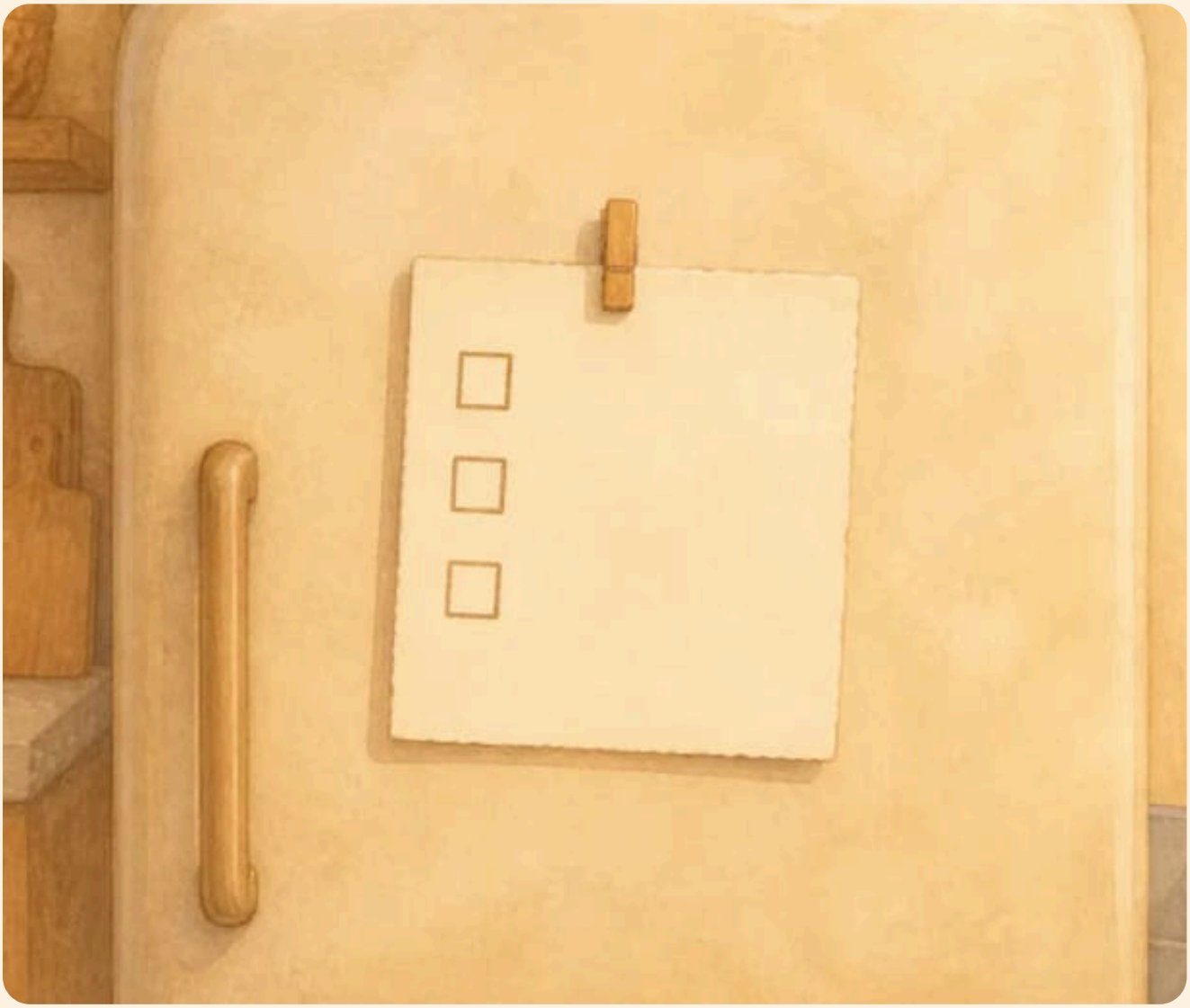
WHAT TO REMEMBER

Try this week

- [ ] Say no to one thing that drains you
- [ ] Choose one private pleasure
- [ ] Keep one simple ritual such as a bedtime song or shared breakfast

EXTRAS FOR YOUR STYLE

- [ ] Pick one routine and keep it all the way to the weekend.
- [ ] Set one limit and hold it to the end.
- [ ] After you name the feeling, stay quiet for ten seconds before anything else.
- [ ] Stop at the first try if they say that's enough.



FOR YOU FIRST

5 ways to come back to yourself

Chosen from your style: what you spend yourself on is what needs releasing. Not one of these is for your child.

There's an order most of us have backwards: everyone else gets looked after first, and you get whatever is left. But what's left at nine at night isn't you — it's the part of you that never got to rest.

The next five pages don't ask you to be a better parent. Nothing here is counted, nothing is reported, and not one of them is for your child. They're all for you, and they aren't a reward you have to earn first.

What's on them isn't random either. Every parenting style spends itself differently: some parents run out from anticipating, some from deciding, some from holding everybody's feelings. So whatever drains you most is also what most needs releasing.



WHAT DRAINS YOU MOST

F — HOW YOU ORGANIZE THE DAY

Deciding without a rail. Every hour asks for a fresh decision.

G — WHO SETS THE DIRECTION

Waiting and holding back. Following someone else's pace all day is work.

T — WHEN THE FEELINGS GET BIG

Absorbing feelings. Your ears have been on shift since morning.

E — COMFORT ZONE OR STRETCH ZONE

Being the energy. Every bit of the fun sets off from you first.

FOR YOU FIRST

Choose pleasure that needs no audience and does not have to become a family memory.

HOW TO USE THESE

Take just one. If only one of these gets used this week, that worked. The rest stay here; they aren't going anywhere.

No time this week? You are still enough.



TIME 5 MIN

One drink while it's still hot

Almost every parent drinks their coffee cold. Not from lack of time, but because there is always one more thing that comes first.

Sit down. Finish the whole thing at its actual temperature, doing nothing else at the same time.



TIME 2 MIN

One anchor for tomorrow

You decide all day because your day has no rail. One fixed point isn't a schedule; it's one less decision.

Pick one thing that will happen at the same time tomorrow. The same breakfast, the same song, the same walk.



TIME 2 MIN

One decision that is only yours

You spend the day following everyone else's pace. One small uncompromised choice gives back something invisible.

Decide one thing today with nobody consulted: the song, the drink, the window open or closed.



TIME 10 MIN

Ten minutes with no voices

Your ears have been on shift since morning — hearing, naming, soothing. Ten wordless minutes isn't loneliness, it's a break.

No podcast, no music with words, no conversation. Ten minutes.



TIME 5 MIN

The boring route, on purpose

Repetition isn't a failure of imagination. It's the rest your imagination is asking for.

Take the familiar way. Order the usual. Just this once, don't look for the new thing.

5 activities with your child (0–5)

One for each age range, so you can take the one that fits your child right now. Everything is already in your house.



THEN, FOR YOUR CHILD

Your child enjoys your spontaneity and benefits from one steady ritual, especially when the energy at home changes.



0–12 MONTHS · 10 MIN

Just out of reach

Babies learn movement from effort, not from being handed things. That small gap is where the trying happens.

1. Lay your baby on a firm, flat surface.
2. Put one interesting object a hand's width past their fingers.
3. Say nothing and wait, even when it takes a while. Don't slide it closer.

You'll need: One object with texture or a soft sound.

Safety first: Firm surface, never a bed or a sofa edge. The object must be too big to pass through a toilet-paper tube.

Grounded in: Montessori — freedom of movement



1–2 YEARS · 10 MIN

Walk the tape line

One line becomes a balance beam, a road, or nothing at all. Whatever they turn it into is the activity.

1. Run a straight or curved line of tape along the floor.
2. Walk it once yourself, then stop directing.
3. Follow whatever rules they invent, even if they change every minute.

You'll need: Masking or washi tape.

Safety first: Clear the run of hard furniture corners. Bare feet or grippy socks.

Grounded in: Montessori — freedom of movement



2–3 YEARS · 10 MIN

Sort it your way

You supply the objects; they supply the rule. Their rule is the point.

1. Tip out 10–15 mixed household objects and two empty bowls.
2. Say "you can sort these however you like", then stay quiet.
3. If they sort by something you'd never have chosen, that's the successful version.

You'll need: Large buttons, bottle caps, spoons, blocks, socks.

Safety first: Every object must be too large for a toilet-paper tube and have no sharp edges. An adult stays with them.

Grounded in: Montessori — sensorial



3–4 YEARS · 20 MIN

Special play time

This is the weekly session used in filial therapy, run by the parent at home. If you try only one activity in this booklet, make it this one.

1. 20 minutes, one child, a consistent time and place, phone in another room.
2. They choose everything. You follow, and join in only when invited — no teaching, no questions, no suggestions.
3. Describe what you see ("You're giving the baby a bottle"), reflect what they feel ("That surprised you"), and praise the effort, never the result ("You kept trying until you got it").
4. Give a five-minute and a one-minute warning before you stop.

You'll need: Simple non-mechanical things: paper and crayons, a doll, animals, blocks, cars.

Safety first: Use intact, age-appropriate toys with no loose batteries or small parts. An adult stays in the room.

Grounded in: Filial therapy — special play time



4–5 YEARS · 15 MIN

A treasure map of our house

Drawing a map and then following it is symbolic thinking with legs.

1. They draw a map of a room, however inaccurate.
2. Hide a small soft toy or block together and mark it.
3. Follow their map, not your knowledge of the house.

You'll need: Paper, crayons, one small soft toy or block to hide.

Safety first: Agree which rooms are in play. If a child under three lives in the home, choose an object too large for a toilet-paper tube.

Grounded in: Montessori — order



No play today? You are still enough.

Keep it, print it, or forget it

This booklet has no targets and counts nothing. Take the one thing that helps and leave the rest.



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